

Biblioteca

Guia do Usuário

Versão do programa: 1.9.20

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Introdução

O que o programa faz

Biblioteca is a catalogue of your personal library. For each book it keeps the title, the authors, the subjects, the year, where your copy sits in the house, a note of your own, the cover photo and whether the book is lent out. From that you can search any of those fields, filter, print a book's record, export a selection to Excel and see on a map where the authors you read come from. This is the Windows version. It is an ordinary program, with its own icon and its own window — not a website, and it does not need the internet to work. The internet is used only when you ask for it: when looking a book up by ISBN. The same catalogue is read by the Mac, iPhone and Android apps, because all of them write to the same file.

Informações de entrada

A text file called biblioteca.txt, which is your library. Each line is one book, with the fields separated by tabs (the TSV format). If you keep that file in iCloud Drive, Biblioteca finds it on its own the first time it opens. Beside it, optionally, a biblioteca.dat file holding the cover photos and a grupos.json holding the names of your reading groups. All three live in the same folder, and the program looks after all of them.

Resultados produzidos

The biblioteca.txt file itself, rewritten on every change — there is no save button, and nothing is ever left pending. On demand: a book's record laid out for printing, a report of your search with the filters applied, an .xlsx spreadsheet of the selected books, and automatic backups in a Backups folder beside your file.

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Instalação

Biblioteca for Windows comes as a single installer of about 1.8 MB. It needs nothing installed beforehand: the program carries everything it needs. It runs on Windows 10 and 11. One thing to expect: the installer itself speaks Portuguese only, even though the program speaks both languages. The steps below give the Portuguese wording you will see on screen, with the English meaning beside it.

Windows 10 or 11

The installer is per user — it does not ask for an administrator password and writes everything inside your own account, under C:\Users\[your name]\AppData\Local\Biblioteca.

1. Download Biblioteca-Windows-setup.exe from https://ruggierow.github.io/biblioteca/ and double-click it.
2. Windows shows a blue screen saying "O Windows protegeu o seu PC" (Windows protected your PC). Click "Mais informações" (More info) and then "Executar assim mesmo" (Run anyway). This appears because the installer has no paid code-signing certificate, not because anything is wrong with it.
3. On the first page of the wizard, click "Próximo" (Next).
4. The second page shows where the program will be installed. Nothing needs changing: click "Instalar" (Install).
5. When it finishes, leave "Abrir a Biblioteca agora" (Open Biblioteca now) ticked and click "Concluir" (Finish).
6. If you already had an earlier version, CLOSE IT before installing. The installer cannot replace a program that is running, and stops with the message "Erro ao abrir o arquivo pra gravação" (Error opening file for writing).

Como confirmar que a instalação funcionou

The program opens in a window titled "Biblioteca v1.9.19", with a blue-to-green gradient header. If your library already existed, the list of books appears filled in at the foot of the page, with the count to the right of the "Books" heading. If this is the first time, the "biblioteca.txt file" strip asks you to link your file.

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The window and the language

Everything happens on a single page, read from top to bottom: first the form for adding a book, then search, editing, the indexes, the file strip and, last, the list of books. The header stays in view at the top, with the language selector and the quit button.

Passo a passo

1. To change the language, click the selector at the top right and choose English or Português.
2. The change takes effect at once, without restarting, and is remembered the next time you open the program.
3. To close the program use the "Quit" button in the header — it writes anything pending before leaving.



Figura 1: The header, with the language selector and the Quit button

Exemplos de uso

- The first time you open the program the language follows Windows: on a Portuguese Windows it opens in Portuguese; in any other language, it opens in English.
- Once you pick a language in the selector, your choice wins from then on — even if Windows is set to another language.

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The first time: the file appears by itself

On Windows there is nothing to set up. You do not need to create a biblioteca.txt beforehand, nor copy one from another computer: the program creates the folder and the file by itself, the first time you add a book. That is why Windows is the only one of the four platforms that asks nothing when it first opens. The Mac shows a window with three choices; the iPhone and Android ask you to pick the folder. Here, it does not.

Passo a passo

1. Open the program. The list is empty and "The biblioteca.txt file" band does not point anywhere yet. That is expected.
2. Add your first book, in the block at the top. The title is enough.
3. That is it: the file now exists. "The biblioteca.txt file" band shows its full path.
4. If you already have a biblioteca.txt from another computer, do not add anything first: use "Import (one-off)" in the file band and point at it.

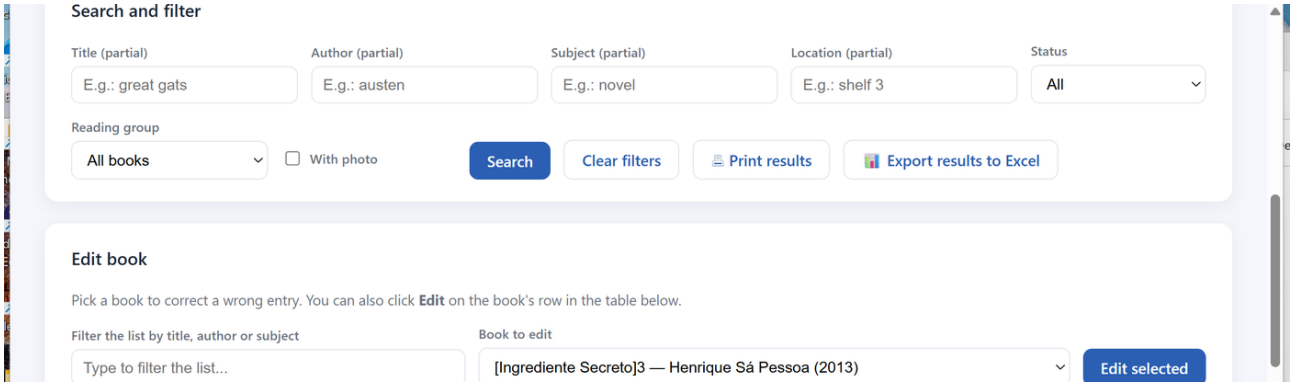


Figura 2: The file band, showing biblioteca.txt's full path

Exemplos de uso

- Where it creates it: if you have iCloud for Windows installed, in C:\Users\[you]\iCloudDrive\Biblioteca — the same folder the Mac and the iPhone use, which already puts the three in step. If you do not, in Documents\Biblioteca.
- To check where it ended up, read the status line at the top of "The biblioteca.txt file" band: it shows the full path.
- And biblioteca.dat, for the covers? It is not born with the other one. It only comes into existence once you have covers and use "Export photos → iCloud Drive". Until then nothing is missing: the program works without it.

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Adding a book

The first block on the page. It adds a book to the catalogue; the only thing it truly needs is a title.

Passo a passo

1. If you have the ISBN at hand, type it in the first field and click "Look up ISBN": the title, authors and year come back filled in from the internet.
2. Fill in or correct the Title. It is the only required field.
3. Click "+ Add author" once per author, and "+ Add subject" once per subject.
4. Fill in the Year, where the copy is (where the book sits in your house) and, if you wish, the Country.
5. Use Notes for whatever is yours: a summary, a memory, who gave it to you.
6. If the book was discussed in a reading group, tick the box and choose the groups.
7. Under "Cover photo", click "Choose photo..." to pick an image from the computer.
8. Click "Add book". The book appears in the list and the file is written at once.

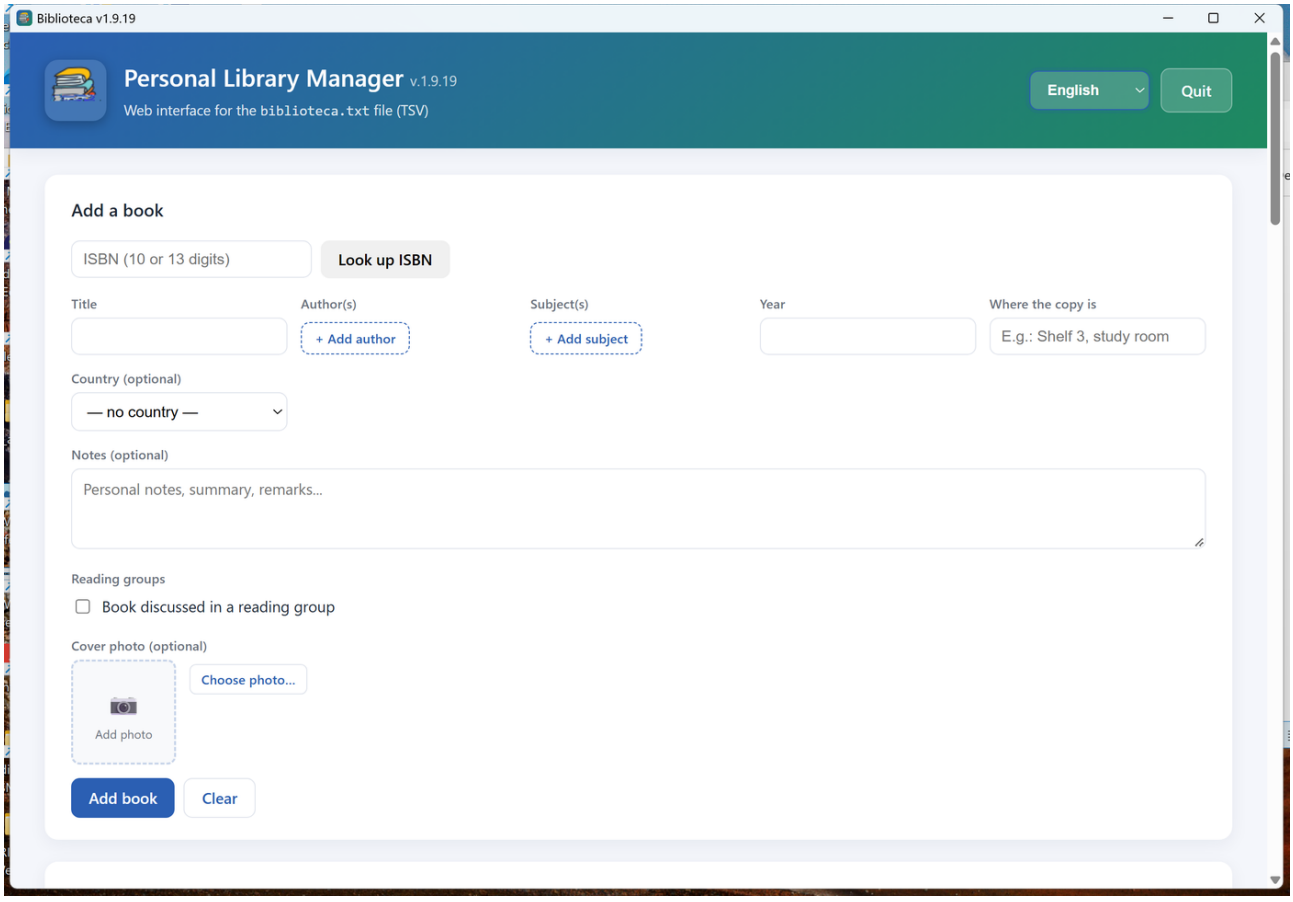


Figura 3: The form for adding a book, with every field of a record

Exemplos de uso

- Quick entry: type only the title and click Add book. The other fields can be filled in later, through editing.
- Entry by ISBN: type 9780140449136 and click Look up ISBN. Check what comes back — the lookup gets the title right nearly always, but sometimes returns the author's name in an order different from yours.
- The "Clear" button empties the form without adding anything, which helps when you change your mind halfway.

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Search and filter

The "Search and filter" block looks for parts of words in four fields at once, and also filters by status, reading group and whether a cover is present. The filters add up: the more you fill in, the narrower the result.

Passo a passo

1. Type part of what you are after in Title, Author, Subject or Location — it need not be the whole word, and case does not matter.
2. Under Status, choose between all, available or lent out.
3. Under Reading group, pick a group to see only the books discussed in it.
4. Tick "With photo" to see only books that already have a cover.
5. Click "Search". The list of books at the foot of the page now shows only the result.
6. "Clear filters" brings the whole list back.

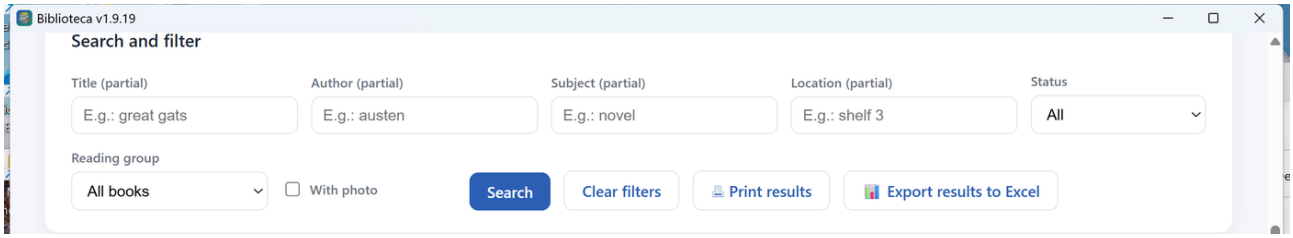


Figura 4: The search fields, with the print and export buttons

Exemplos de uso

- By author: type "austen" in Author and click Search — every book of hers comes back, even if you entered the full name.
- Finding a book on the shelf: type "shelf 3" in Location to see everything kept there.
- Two filters together: "novel" in Subject plus Status "Lent" shows which novels are out of the house.
- With a result on screen, "Print results" produces a report with the filters you used written at the top, and "Export results to Excel" writes the same selection to a spreadsheet.

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Editing a book

This is how you correct a record. The "Edit book" block holds a list of every book and a field that narrows it as you type.

Passo a passo

1. Type part of the title, author or subject in the filter field.
2. Pick the book from the "Book to edit" list.
3. Click "Edit selected". The form opens with the current values filled in.
4. Change what you need and save.
5. The same form opens from the "Edit" button on the book's own row, in the table at the foot of the page — usually quicker when you are already looking at the list.

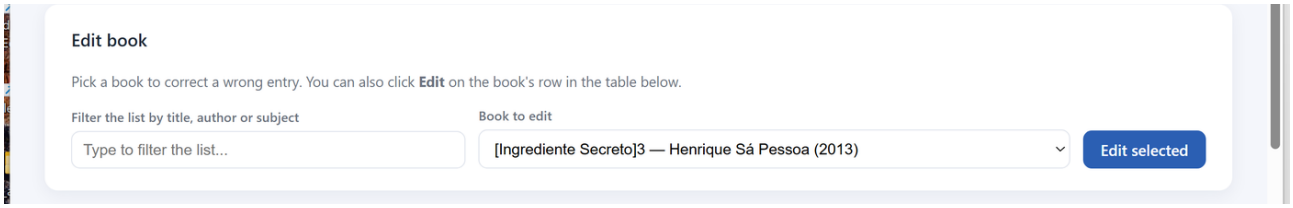


Figura 5: Choosing the book to edit, with the filter beside it

Exemplos de uso

- Fixing a wrong year: filter by title, select, edit the Year field and save.
- Adding a cover to an old record: edit the book and use "Choose photo..."; the cover then shows in the first column of the list.

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Subjects and authors

Two indexes side by side, each with the number of books under every subject and every author. They serve both to see your collection from above and to filter it with one click.

Passo a passo

1 Click the "Subjects and authors" heading to open or close the block.

2 Use the filter fields to find an item in a long list.

3 Click a subject or an author: the list of books at the foot of the page narrows to that item.

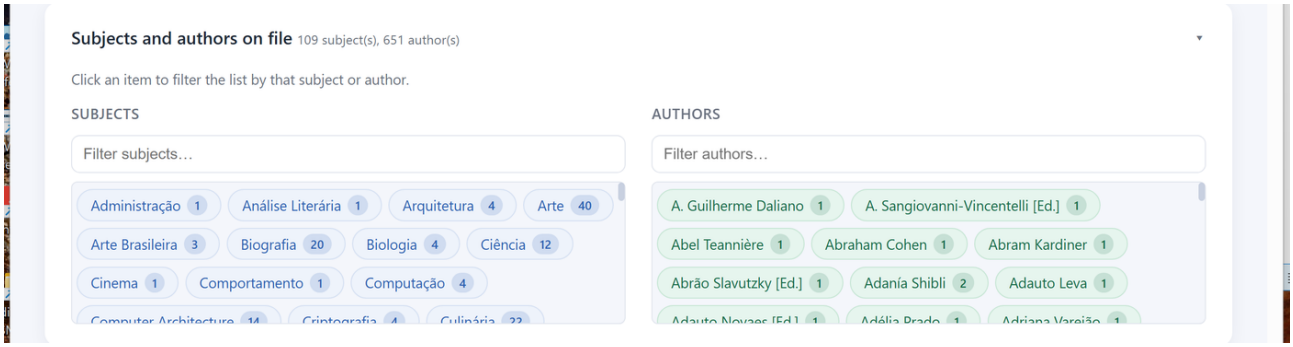


Figura 6: The subject and author indexes, each entry with its count

Exemplos de uso

- The number beside a name is how many books you have under that subject or author — "Art 40" means forty books on Art.
- It is the quickest answer to "how many books of this author do I have?" without typing anything.

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The biblioteca.txt file

The file strip is where the program tells you which file it is working with, and offers everything to do with it: reload, import, export and back up. It is also where the button that erases everything lives.

Passo a passo

1 The status line at the top of the strip says whether a file is linked and when it was read.

2 "Reload" reads the file from disk again — useful when you changed the library on another device and want that change here.

3 "Import" reads a biblioteca.txt from somewhere else; the Excel import reads a reading-group spreadsheet.

4 "Export" writes a copy of the catalogue wherever you choose.

5 The photo export sends the covers to the iCloud Drive folder.

6 "Backup" writes a dated copy into the Backups folder.

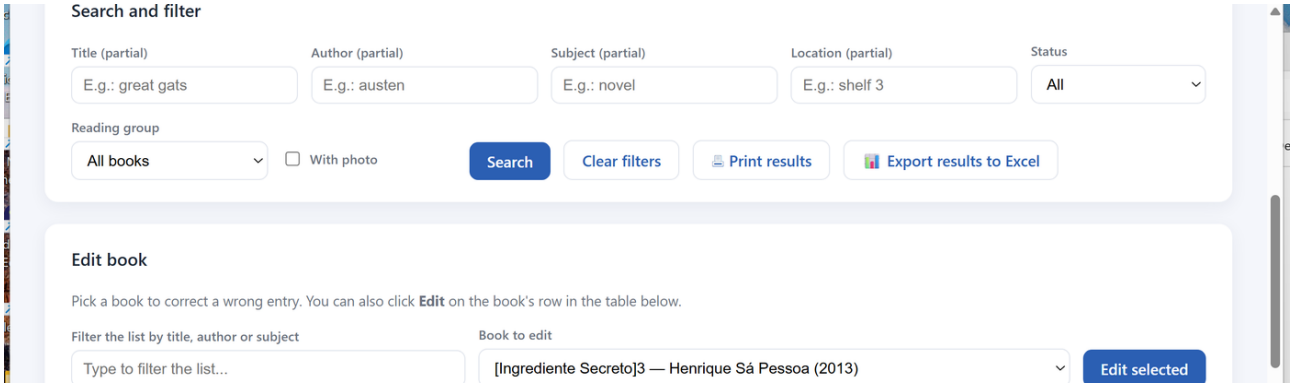


Figura 7: The file strip, with import, export and backup

Exemplos de uso

- There is no save button: every change is written to the file the moment you make it.
- Before the first write of each session the program keeps a copy of the previous state in Backups — 30 generations of the .txt and 7 of the .dat.
- "Erase everything" is destructive and asks for confirmation. It empties the catalogue, not just the screen.

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The list of books

The last block on the page is the table of books, ten to a page. It shows the cover, title, authors, subjects, year, status, location, note and groups — and carries, on every row, the buttons that act on that book.

Passo a passo

1. The count to the right of the heading says how many books are being shown out of the total — "757 of 757" means no filter is active.
2. Use the paging controls below the table to move through the pages.
3. "Edit" opens the book in the edit form.
4. "Lend" marks the book as lent and asks who has it.
5. "Print" produces that book's record.
6. "Remove" deletes the book, with confirmation.

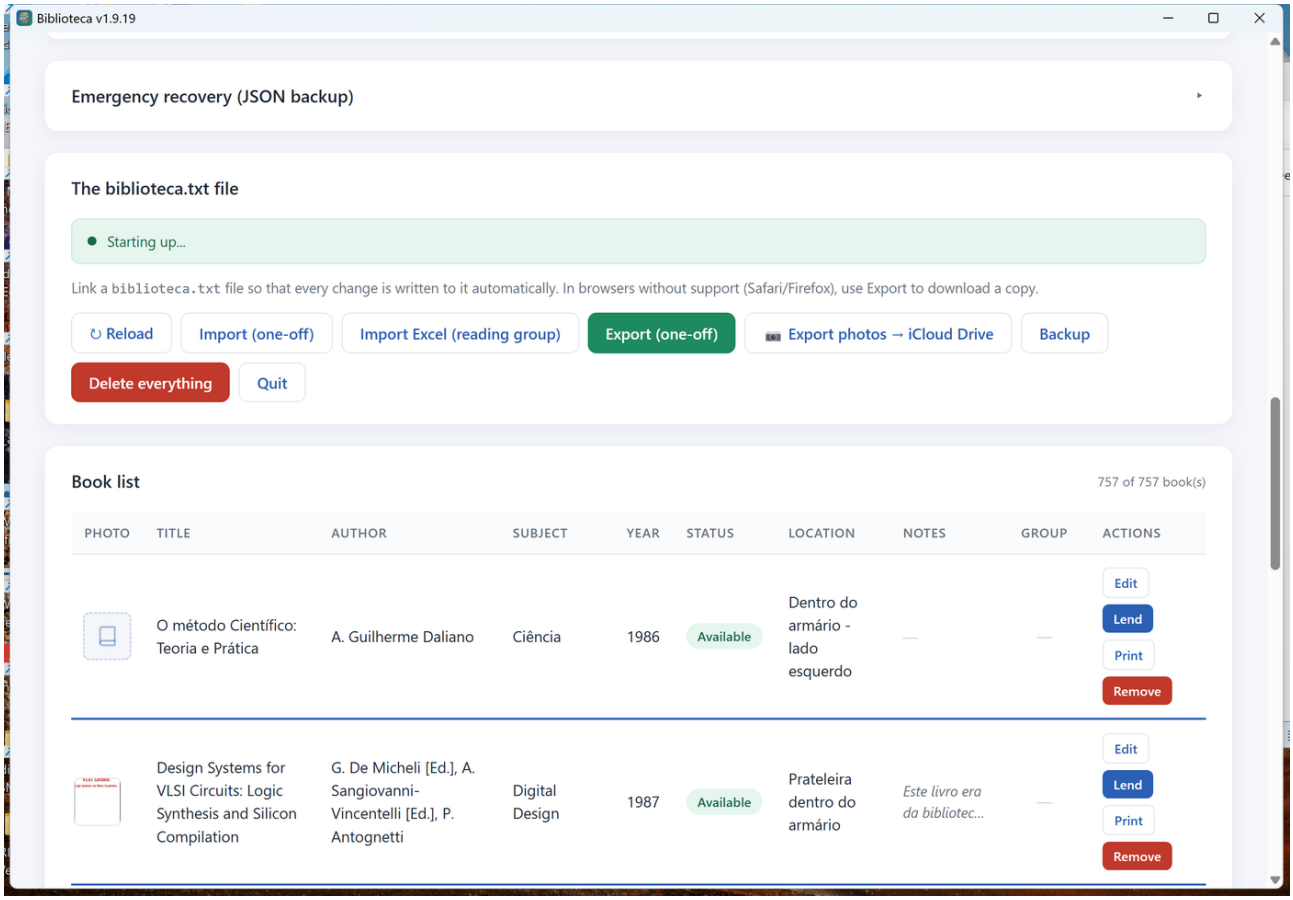


Figura 8: The table of books, with covers and the buttons on each row

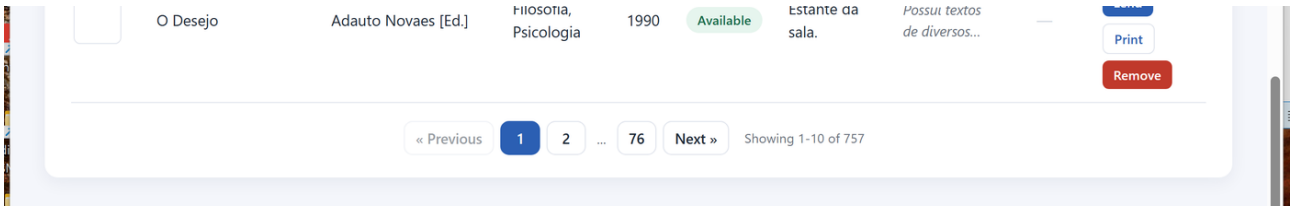


Figura 9: Paging and the count, at the foot of the table

Exemplos de uso

- When a book's note holds a web address, the column shows "Read" and "Kindle" links, which open the book in the browser or in the Kindle app.
- The group column shows the name of the reading group the book was discussed in, not merely a "yes".
- Books with no cover show a grey book icon in place of the photo.

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Tutorial: from the installer to your first book with a cover

This walkthrough goes from nothing installed to having one book catalogued, with its cover, and knowing how to find it again. It takes about ten minutes.

1. Download Biblioteca-Windows-setup.exe from the app's page and run it. On the blue Windows screen, click "Mais informações" and "Executar assim mesmo".
2. Click "Próximo" and then "Instalar". When it finishes, leave "Abrir a Biblioteca agora" ticked and click "Concluir".
3. The program opens. If your biblioteca.txt is in iCloud Drive it is already loaded; if not, use the import button in the file strip to point at it.
4. If the program opened in Portuguese, switch to English in the selector at the top right.
5. Go to the "Add a book" block. Type the ISBN of a book you have at hand and click "Look up ISBN".
6. Check what came back, add where the copy is — "Shelf 3, study room", say — and a note of your own.
7. Under "Cover photo", click "Choose photo..." and pick an image of the cover.
8. Click "Add book". The book goes into the list and the file is written at once.
9. Now find it again: in "Search and filter", type part of the title and click "Search". The table at the foot of the page shows just that book, cover and all.

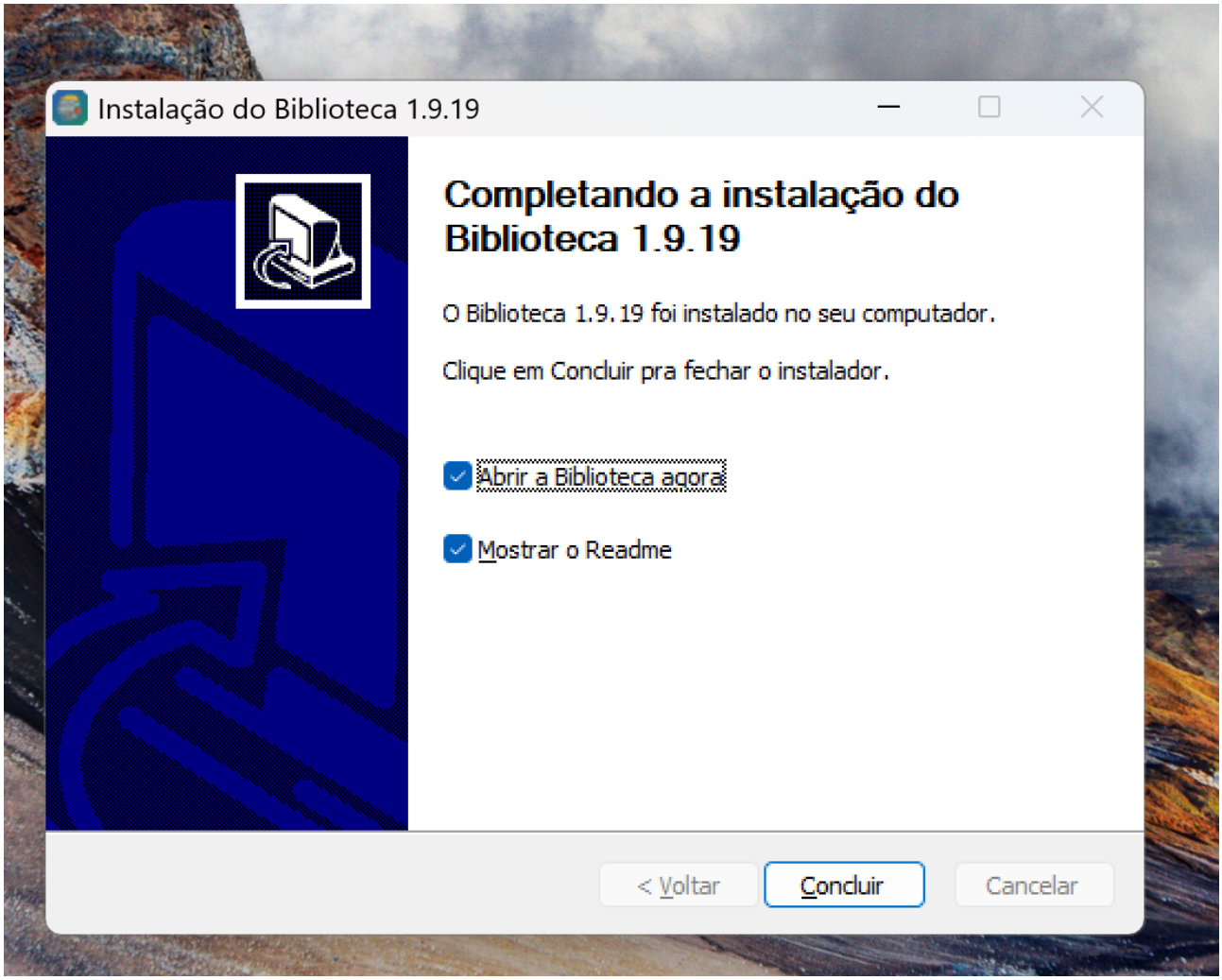


Figura 10: The end of the installation, with the option to open the program (the installer is in Portuguese)

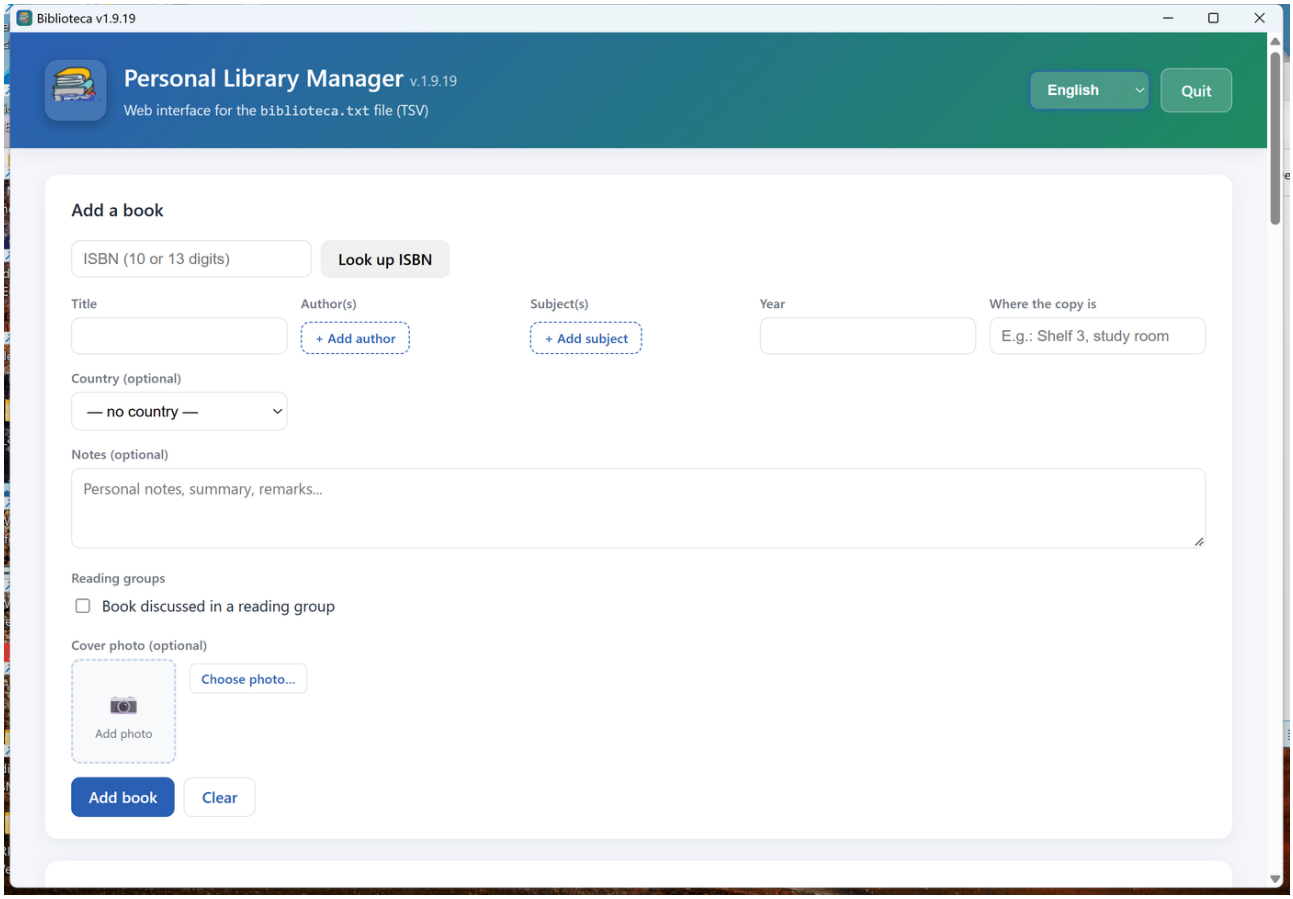


Figura 11: The form where the tutorial's book is added

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Solução de Problemas

I installed the program and I do not know how to create my biblioteca.txt.

You do not need to. Add your first book and the program creates the folder and the file by itself — in iCloudDrive\Biblioteca if you have iCloud for Windows, or in Documents\Biblioteca. The full path shows in "The biblioteca.txt file" band.

I do not have a biblioteca.dat. What am I missing?

Nothing. It only comes into existence once you have covers and use "Export photos → iCloud Drive". Without it the program works just the same; what does not happen is the iPhone and Android seeing your covers.

Windows shows a blue screen: "O Windows protegeu o seu PC".

Click "Mais informações" and then "Executar assim mesmo". The warning appears because the installer has no paid code-signing certificate — the same warning would appear for any program made at home. It is not a virus alert.

The installer stops with "Erro ao abrir o arquivo pra gravação: ...\Biblioteca.exe".

The program is running, and Windows will not let a file in use be replaced. Click "Abortar", close Biblioteca and run the installer again.

The installer is in Portuguese.

It is, and only in Portuguese — the program speaks both languages but the installer carries one. The installation steps in this manual give the Portuguese wording with its English meaning.

The program opened in Portuguese.

That is expected when Windows is set to Portuguese: on first opening, the program follows the system language. Switch it in the header selector and your choice will be remembered.

The list of books is empty.

Look at the file strip: if no file is linked, use the import button and point at your biblioteca.txt. If one is linked, check whether a search filter is active — click "Clear filters".

I changed the library on my phone and this still shows the old version.

Click "Reload" in the file strip. The program reads the file when it opens, and does not watch for changes made by another device while it is running.

The ISBN lookup does not find the book.

Not every book is in the databases consulted, especially older and smaller editions. Enter it by hand: only the title is required.

I deleted a book by mistake.

Look in the Backups folder beside your biblioteca.txt. The program keeps a copy of the previous state before the first write of each session, with the date and time in the file name.

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Glossário

Biblioteca
The program's name, Portuguese for "library". In the English interface it presents itself as Personal Library Manager; the window title and the installer keep the original name.

biblioteca.dat
The file holding the cover photos, beside biblioteca.txt. It grows large over time, because each cover is an image.

ISBN
The international number identifying an edition of a book. It has 10 or 13 digits and is usually on the back cover, next to the barcode.

Reading group
A reading group you take part in. The program records which groups each book was discussed in, and a book may belong to more than one.

TSV
The format of the biblioteca.txt file: one line per book, fields separated by tabs. It is plain text, which any editor can open.

Where the copy is
Where the book physically sits in your house — "Shelf 3", "bedroom cupboard". It is a free text field, and it is what makes the catalogue actually useful for finding a book.

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Referências

- The app's page, with installers for all four platforms: https://ruggierow.github.io/biblioteca/
- Every version and what changed in it: https://github.com/ruggierow/biblioteca/releases
- Privacy policy: https://ruggierow.github.io/biblioteca/privacidade.html

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